WINDOWS DESKTOP APPLICATION / USER MANUAL

Greek to Greeklish Renamer

Rename confidently. Preview every change.
Keep English filenames untouched.

Remembered settings / Cancel scan / History

Safe renaming / Undo / Standalone EXE

VERSION 2.5.0 / OPEN SOURCE / MIT LICENSE

Created by Dimitris Laidis

github.com/DimitrisLai/Greek-to-greeklish-renamer

01 / Start here

Choose the correct download, then complete a safe first run in a few minutes.

Which file should I download?

DOWNLOAD	WHO IT IS FOR
Windows ZIP (recommended)	Contains the compiled **GreeklishRenamer.exe**, PDF manual, license and quick-start text. **No Python installation.**
Source ZIP	For developers and Python users: GUI, command-line edition, tests, documentation and build scripts.
PDF User Manual	This document; also included in the Windows ZIP.

Your first scan in six steps

- **1.** Download the Windows ZIP from the v2.5.0 GitHub Release.
- **2.** Right-click the ZIP and choose **Extract All**.
- **3.** Double-click **GreeklishRenamer.exe**.
- **4.** Browse to a test folder with a few Greek filenames.
- **5.** Choose a file-type filter and click **Preview changes**. Cancel scan if needed.
- **6.** Find and untick unwanted entries; correct a proposed name; apply only checked rows.

START SAFELY

Make a separate backup before bulk changes. The preview does not modify files. A CSV undo log is created for each applied run.

02 / Meet the desktop interface

A focused window for selecting a folder, reviewing changes, applying renames and restoring names.

Screen guide

AREA	WHAT IT DOES
Folder location	Browse to select a folder; the last existing directory is remembered locally.
File-type filter	All, audio, MP3, FLAC, WAV or custom extensions; last choice is remembered.
Preview / Cancel scan	Live file/folder counters; cancelling discards the partial scan without renaming.
Explorer menu (classic)	Optional per-user right-click preview under Show more options on Windows 11.
Select All / Select None toggle	One toggle switches between Select None (all checked) and Select All (otherwise).
Edit selected…	Edit a proposed name. File extensions are protected unless you explicitly opt into advanced changes.
Find / Show filters	Search original or proposed paths; show All, Included, Excluded or Edited. Selection remains unchanged.
Apply / Stop safely	Apply checked names, or request a safe stop between filenames. Window closing is blocked while busy.
Results / Undo	Review per-file outcomes and reasons. Keep the separate undo CSV.
History / Black theme	Review undo logs or switch between Light and Black appearance without losing your preview; your theme choice is saved.

Safety: Saved settings never start a scan automatically; filtered views do not alter selections.

03 / The preview-first workflow

The application is designed to make each proposed change visible before committing it.

What you see before renaming

TYPE	CURRENT PATH	PROPOSED PATH
File	Ελληνικά.mp3	Ellinika.mp3
File	DJ - Ελληνικά.flac	DJ - Ellinika.flac
Folder	Μουσική	Mousiki
File	Αθήνα/Τραγούδι.mp3	Αθήνα/Tragoudi.mp3

Choose, correct and apply only what you want

- Each row starts checked; click INCLUDE or press Space to toggle it.
- One button toggles **Select All / Select None** across every row, even those hidden by filters.
- Select a row and use **Edit selected** to correct its name. Extensions are locked unless explicitly unlocked in the advanced option.
- Search original/proposed names, or filter Included, Excluded or Edited; hidden rows keep their selections. Apply only checked rows.
- If the directory changes after preview, Apply is rejected and a fresh preview is required.
- Uncheck a parent folder if you exclude a proposed rename inside it.
- **Stop safely** finishes the current file and saves its undo entry; do not force-close the app.
- Results show renamed, skipped, failed, excluded and unprocessed items with reasons.

DO NOT TREAT PREVIEW AS A FILE-CONTENT COMPARISON

This tool modifies filenames and directory names, not media metadata, contents, lyrics or audio. It does not compare hashes or file quality.

04 / Folders and subdirectories

Control scope independently: scan inside subfolders, and optionally rename the subfolders themselves.

INCLUDE SUBDIRECTORIES	RENAME GREEK FOLDERS	BEHAVIOR
Off (default)	Disabled	Only files directly inside the selected folder are considered.
On	Off	Files are considered recursively; folder names remain unchanged.
On	On	Files and Greek-named folders are candidates for renaming.

Example: an artist collection

```
BEFORE  /  Music / Ελληνικά / Τραγούδι.mp3

AFTER   /  Music / Ellinika / Tragoudi.mp3
```

With the second option disabled, **Ελληνικά** remains the same folder name, while **Τραγούδι.mp3** becomes **Tragoudi.mp3**.

Linked directories are excluded

- Recursive scans skip symbolic links and Windows junction / reparse points.
- The selected root directory must be a normal accessible folder, not a link.
- Folder moves are performed after filenames inside the folder, so the undo log can restore paths in reverse order.

05 / Greek-to-Greeklish rules

Simple ASCII transcription inspired by ELOT 743 / ISO 843, with Greek accents removed.

ORIGINAL	RESULT	NOTES
Γιώργος Μαζωνάκης.mp3	Giorgos Mazonakis.mp3	Greek name example
Δημήτρης Κόκοτας.flac	Dimitris Kokotas.flac	File extension preserved
DJ - Ελληνικά.mp3	DJ - Ellinika.mp3	Mixed Latin / Greek
Χρήστος.mp3	Christos.mp3	χ → ch
Μπάμπης.mp3	Bampis.mp3	Context-dependent μπ
Αυτοκίνητο.mp3	Aftokinito.mp3	Context-dependent αυ
English Song.mp3	Unchanged	No Greek letters

A note about spelling

Personal names have more than one accepted Latin spelling. This software aims for consistent filename-friendly ASCII results; it is **not a certified, fully reversible or exhaustive ELOT 743 implementation**. Review names that matter to you.

GREEK-ONLY FILTER

The application examines each file or folder **name**, never its content. English or already-Greeklish names are skipped.

06 / Safety, conflicts and undo

The GUI protects unrelated names, but important collections should still be backed up.

Collision behavior

EXISTING NAME	GREEK ORIGINAL	RESULT
Ellinika.mp3	Ελληνικά.mp3	Ellinika (2).mp3
Ellinika (2).mp3	Ελληνικά.mp3	Ellinika (3).mp3 (if needed)

Restoring names

- Keep the **greeklish_rename_log_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS_microseconds.csv** created in the chosen folder.
- Click **History...** to list the recent undo logs in the selected folder and review their entries.
- Choose **Undo selected run** from History or **Undo from CSV** for an older external log.
- The separate **greeklish_result_log_*.csv** lists success, skipped, failed, excluded and not processed with reasons.
- Verify that the folder is correct, then type the exact word **UNDO**.
- Atomic no-overwrite moves prevent accidental replacement if a destination becomes occupied. Undo also refuses occupied original names.
- Preview and results CSV exports escape spreadsheet formula-like cells. Undo CSVs retain exact names for reliable restoration.

UNDO IS NOT AN INDEPENDENT BACKUP

Do not delete your separate backups until you verify the results. A crash, locked file, moved directory, concurrent changes or filesystem error can prevent full restoration.

07 / Source edition and command line

The original command-line renamer remains available for automation and users who prefer console controls.

Run the Python GUI (source edition)

```
py greeklish_gui.py
py greeklish_gui.py --version
py greeklish_gui.py --self-test
```

Keep using the command-line edition

```
py rename_greek_to_greeklish.py
py rename_greek_to_greeklish.py --path "D:/Music" --dry-run
py rename_greek_to_greeklish.py --path "D:/Music" --recursive
py rename_greek_to_greeklish.py --path "D:/Music" --recursive --files-only
```

Undo from PowerShell or Command Prompt

```
py rename_greek_to_greeklish.py --path "D:/Music"
  --undo "D:/Music/greeklish_rename_log_...csv"
```

The two-line undo example above is conceptual; put it on one command line, or use the GUI. The **--yes** flag skips the CLI confirmation prompt and should only be used deliberately.

08 / Troubleshooting

Quick checks for common problems in the Windows UI and Python source edition.

PROBLEM	WHAT TO DO
The EXE does not open	Extract ZIP first. SmartScreen may prompt for unsigned community applications.
Nothing found	Check the selected folder and subdirectory option. Only names containing Greek letters qualify.
Apply is disabled	Run Preview and check at least one row; changing options clears the preview.
Search hides filenames	Search and status filters hide rows only; their Include state remains unchanged.
Scan takes too long	Click Cancel scan; the preview is discarded, no files renamed. Run Preview again when ready.
Applying takes long	Use Stop safely to finish the current rename and retain logs.
Edited name is rejected	File extensions are protected by default. For a deliberate extension change, enable the advanced checkbox.
Unchecked child blocks Apply	Uncheck the selected parent folder too, or explicitly select the child.
Folder changed before apply	Run Preview again; the stale plan is intentionally rejected.
Access denied / locked file	Close music players, editors or sync clients. Check permissions and try again.
Undo restores only some rows	Review the CSV and check for moved/missing files or occupied original names.
History is empty	Choose the original target folder. History only shows undo CSVs located directly inside that folder.
Source GUI fails to start	Confirm Python 3.10+ includes Tkinter. Use the standalone EXE if Python is not available.

Note: Test the standalone EXE on your own Windows desktop before large-batch use.

09 / Project information

Release details, support channels and responsible use.

ITEM	DETAIL
Project	Greek to Greeklish Renamer
Release	v2.5.0 — Remembered Settings & Cancel Scan
Author	Dimitris Laidis / GitHub: DimitrisLai
License	MIT (source code); dependencies keep their respective terms
Source runtime	Python 3.10+, standard library (Tkinter)
Windows build	Standalone, installer-free EXE packaged using PyInstaller
Repository	github.com/DimitrisLai/Greek-to-greeklish-renamer
Support	GitHub Issues (use fictional example filenames)

New in version 2.4.0

- Last valid folder and file-type choices are saved locally and restored without running a scan.
- Cancel a slow Preview scan; cancelled scans do not rename files or create undo logs.
- Scan cancellation is separate from Stop safely for a rename already being applied.
- Modern Windows 11 top-level context menus require a native signed package; the optional classic menu remains under Show more options.
- Existing History/Undo, collision safeguards, CSV protections and extension filters remain available.

PRIVACY AND RESPONSIBLE USE

The application operates locally. It does not upload filenames or file data. Keep separate backups, verify previews and avoid posting private folder paths in public issue reports.